

Lost in transit

From packed stadiums and media shuttles to late-night bus terminals and deserted downtowns, our correspondent **pieces together** a World Cup through a collection of vignettes from across the United States.

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It is a rather strange experience covering a football World Cup in the United States.

For starters, everything is measured in miles instead of kilometres, and every stadium seems to be just a little farther away than Google Maps suggests. The tournament has quickly become a lesson in geography, logistics and the American definition of “nearby”.

Journalists have it a little easier than the supporters. FIFA runs dedicated media shuttles from designated hotels. As long as you can make it there on time — very few can afford to stay there, especially reporters from countries where the dollar has developed an unhealthy

climbing obsession — you can get a free ride.

Fans, however, have not been quite as fortunate. Those staying in New York and travelling to New Jersey have probably felt the most aggrieved. A two-way New Jersey Transit pass on match days costs around USD 98, whereas on normal days, the same journey can be made for a little over 20 dollars.

The MetLife Stadium, one of the few venues allowed to keep its

